MAICON

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(AI-Generated Session Notes)

The AI-Native Content Team: How Any Team Can Outproduce (and Out-Innovate) the Competition

Date & time: Oct. 15, 9:15-9:45 AM
Track: Featured Main Stage



Mike Kaput

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Session Description

Today, teams equipped with the right combination of AI models, agents, workflows, and operating principles can achieve outcomes that once required teams many times larger.

In this keynote, SmarterX Chief Content Officer Mike Kaput pulls back the curtain on how his team has redesigned content operations around AI. You'll see the actual workflows, systems, and AI-powered processes that enable a team to produce, experiment, and innovate at a level that would have been impossible just a year ago.

You'll learn:

- The AI-native workflows, agents, and systems powering a high-output content organization
- How to redesign team roles and responsibilities so humans focus on strategy, creativity, and decision-making while AI handles scalable execution
- What separates organizations using AI for incremental efficiency from those using it to fundamentally reinvent how work gets done
- The lessons, challenges, and change-management realities involved in building an AI-native content team

You'll leave with a practical blueprint for building AI-native content operations, increasing team productivity, accelerating innovation, and creating greater business impact, regardless of your team's size.

Key Quote

> *"If AI can create it out of the gate without much input from you, stop creating it. Go find the stuff AI does not know."* **- Mike Kaput**

Session Summary

Mike Kaput, Chief Content Officer at SmarterX and Marketing AI Institute, opened the final day of MAICON with a candid look at what AI is doing to content, content marketing, and content

teams. Drawing on nearly two decades as a journalist, business writer, agency content professional, and AI practitioner, he framed his talk as "first draft thinking": not a definitive answer, but the working playbook SmarterX is actively building and following.

Kaput argued that while marketers have adopted AI, most have not adapted to it. He cited Ahrefs research showing 93% of surveyed marketers now use AI to help create content (up from 87% the prior year), Adobe data showing 25% of consumers now name AI-powered platforms as their top information source (more than name brand websites), Define Media Group findings of a 42% average drop in organic search clicks tied to Google's AI Overviews, and Pew Research Center data showing 35% of sampled pages had significant AI editing or authorship. Together, he said, these trends are inverting the content supply-demand curve: supply is exploding while audience attention falls, because audiences increasingly use AI for the purposes content was meant to serve. Using AI simply to go faster and do more, he warned, means running faster in the wrong direction.

His answer is a five-step AI-native content playbook: original inputs, anchor assets, content portfolio, living knowledge, and an agentic engine. The foundation is original inputs, meaning human insights, data, and ideas AI cannot supply on its own, such as expert interviews, proprietary frameworks, lived experience, and customer conversations. He illustrated this with SmarterX's State of AI for Business survey: 34 questions, 2,100 respondents, more than 100,000 data points, and over 90% of respondents writing in full qualitative answers. Those inputs became an anchor asset, a report whose draft once took at least four weeks and this year took about a week, with an initial draft ready the day after the survey closed, thanks to reusable AI skills, agentic systems such as Claude Code and Codex, and human and agent verification.

From there, each anchor asset feeds a content portfolio spanning articles, visuals, podcast episodes, social posts, weekly stat spotlights, and customized activation briefs for sales, customer success, marketing, operations, and leadership. Kaput then described what SmarterX is building next: living knowledge, such as a queryable archive of 246 podcast episodes and shared repositories with AI layered over them, and research questions now embedded in AI Score to collect always-refreshed data. The final step is an agentic engine of agents that use this knowledge to monitor, recommend, and create.

Kaput closed by urging content professionals to see themselves as managers of compounding systems, maintainers of knowledge repositories, and soon managers of agents. Because they are the originators and sourcers of the inputs AI still does not have, he argued, their role is becoming more valuable, not less.

Key Takeaways

- **Create only what AI can't.** If AI can produce a piece of content without much human input, stop making it and spend that time sourcing original inputs like interviews, proprietary data, and customer conversations.
- **Adapt, don't just accelerate.** Using AI to produce more content faster plays into an inverted supply-demand curve where content supply is exploding while audience attention declines.

- **Use AI for scale, not origination.** Reusable skills that teach AI your voice, standards, and process, paired with human verification, cut SmarterX's report drafting from at least four weeks to about a week.
- **Activate content internally, too.** Anchor assets can be turned into sales enablement materials, training resources, and team-specific activation briefs, bringing content closer to where business gets done.
- **Turn archives into living knowledge.** Putting content in shared repositories that both humans and AI can query, like SmarterX's 246-episode podcast archive, multiplies its value over time.
- **Prepare to manage systems and agents.** Content professionals should build programs as compounding systems rather than individual assets, with agents increasingly working alongside them as specialists.